A-A-20132A
February 11, 1986
SUPERSEDES
A-A-20132
August 20, 1985

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FRANKFURTERS

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers skinless frankfurters.

Salient characteristics.

The frankfurters shall be natural color (no artifical coloring). The interior cut surface shall be smooth, fine textured, light to moderately dark pink in background color, and finely mottled with evenly distributed light to dark red flecks. The frankfurters shall be the formula, size, length, and packaging specified. Frankfurters shall be uniform in length and size.

Formula (label)	Size (Links per pound)	Packaging	Length (inches)
Beef and Pork	10	1 or 2-pound vacuum packaged	4.5 to 6.5
Beef and Pork	10	5 or 10-pound bulk packaged	5.0 to 7.0
Beef and Pork	5	5 or 10-pound bulk packaged	8.5 to 10.5
Beef	4	5 or 10-pound bulk packaged	not more than 6.5

Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Finished product requirements.

The frankfurters shall conform to the requirements in Table II and shall meet the criteria in Table I.

FSC 8905

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Regulatory requirements.

The meat component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA). The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product within the commercial marketplace.

Quality assurance.

When required in the solicitation or contract, quality assurance of the frankfurters shall be determined by Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) agents. The product shall be examined and/or tested in accordance with the applicable provisions in the CID. When applicable, examination of condition of containers shall be in accordance with the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers currently in effect on the date of the solicitation and in accordance with the requirements in applicable regulations.

End item examination.

The end item lot size, expressed in the number of 10-pound units (for product packed other than 10 pounds in a primary container, the lot size and sample shall be the number of 10-pound equivalents) shall be declared to the AMS agent by the contractor. The sample unit shall be 1 frankfurter from each sampled 10-pound unit. Additional samples must be drawn to be examined for Defect 152 in Table II. For reinspection, use the sampling plan for the next largest lot size. Results of reinspection shall be final.

Internal product characteristics examination shall be made on the right-hand cut surface of one longitudinally bisected frankfurter randomly selected from each sample unit.

An immersion test shall be performed to examine for Defect No. 152 and footnote 6/ in Table II. For lot sizes of 50 or less this examination shall be performed on 3 additional selected frankfurters. For larger lots, 5 frankfurters shall be selected. The frankfurters shall be immersed for approximately 10 minutes in 160°F to 180°F (71°C to 82°C) water.

TABLE I. Sampling Plans for External and Internal Product Examination

Lot Size (10 lb equivalents)	Sample Size (Frankfurters)	Major Defects		Total Defects	
		AC	RE	AC	RE
1 - 100	8	0	1	2	3
101 - 300	13	0	1	3	4
301 - 800	32	1	2	7	8
801 - up	50	2	3	10	11
801 and up reinspection	80	3	4	14	15

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TABLE II. Classification of Defects 1/ 2/ 3/ 6/

Major	Minor	Defects
		External Product Characteristics
151		Lacks good resiliency typical of the product.
152		Link is soft, mushy, or abnormally distended or shrunken after immersion in 160°F to 180°F (71°C to 82°C) water for 10 minutes or more (slight curvature acceptable).
153		Number of links in one pound of product not as specified by the purchaser. 4/
154		Length not as specified. 4/ 5/
	201	Presence of all or part of artificial casing, other than collagen casing.
	202	Link having a split or rupture measuring more than 0.3 inch.
	203	Link which is broken.
	204	Link with fat cap or fat streak.
		Internal Product Characteristics
155		Lacks good cohesion typical of the product.
156		Texture not as specified.
157		Any individual cut surface having more than 1 pocket of fat, gelatin, and/or air measuring 0.4 inch or more in any dimension.
158		One or more pieces of material, other than bone, measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension which will not break up or disintegrate when subjected to pressure from the flat side of a knife or spatula.
159		Bone particle measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension.
	205	Any individual cut surface having more than 3 pockets of fat, gelatin, and/or air, that individually measures 0.2 inch or more, but less than 0.4 inch, in any dimension.

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TABLE II. Classification of Defects 1/ 2/ 3/ 6/
(Continued)

Major	Minor	Defects
	206	One or more pieces of material, other than bone, measuring 0.2 inches or more, but less than 0.3 inch, in any dimension which will not break up or disintegrate when subjected to pressure from the flat surface of a knife or spatula.
	207	Bone particle measuring 0.2 inches or more, but less than 0.3 inch in any dimension.

1/ Determination of wholesomeness and acceptability of product with respect to the presence of foreign material (e.g., glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, or metal) shall be made by a Meat and Poultry Inspection Operations employee.

2/ Presence of product which is not in excellent condition (i.e., moldy, stale, slimy, oily, sticky, sour, or discolored) shall cause rejection of the involved lot.

3/ Presence of product which is not of the formula, color, style, size, length, or state of refrigeration specified shall cause rejection of the involved lot.

4/ Determined once per 10-pound unit drawn for sampling.

5/ Examination for uniformity in length shall be performed on the frankfurters selected for examination for Defect No. 153. If the difference in length between the shortest and longest frankfurter measures greater than 0.5 inch, a defect shall be scored.

6/ Presence of foreign taste or odor (e.g., musty, stale, or rancid) shall cause rejection of the involved lot. This determination shall be made on samples heated to be examined for Defect No. 152.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The frankfurter shall be preserved, packaged, packed, and case marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the contract or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

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For Department of Defense procurements.

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer:

A. **Commercial and export packaging.** Same as for commercial practices (see Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking).

B. **Commercial packing.** Not less than 40 pounds nor more than 60 pounds of 1- or 2-pound vacuum packaged frankfurters, or bulk packaged frankfurters in 5- or 10-pound cartons, shall be packed in a fiberboard container complying with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable, except metal fasteners shall not be used in the final closure of the box.

C. **Export packing.** Not less than 40 pounds nor more than 60 pounds of 1- or 2-pound vacuum packaged frankfurters, or bulk packaged frankfurters in 5- or 10-pound cartons, shall be packed into a snug fitting fiberboard box constructed and closed in accordance with Style RSC, Grade W5c or W5s of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be reinforced with nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

D. **Commercial unit loads.** Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with Type III, Class G of MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

E. **Export unit loads.** Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with Type I, Class A of MIL-L-35078. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

F. **Labeling.** Labeling of pouches shall be in accordance with commercial practice and be in compliance with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

G. **Marking.** Commercial markings for shipping containers are acceptable provided the following information is included:

National Stock Number
Date of Packaging (month/year)
Contract Number
Quantity, Unit of Issue
Name, Address, and Zip Code of Contractor

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H. Marking of unit loads (commercial and export). Commercial and export unit loads shall be marked on two adjacent sides with the following information:

National Stock Number
Item Description
Number of Containers per Load, Quantity per Container, Unit of Issue
Commercial or Export Unit Load (as applicable)
Date of Pack (month/year)
Contract Number or Purchase Order Number
Name, Address, and Zip Code of Contractor
Gross Weight (Including Pallet Weight)
Cube

Notes.

Sources of documents:

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
1616 P Street, NW
Washington, DC 20036

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1106
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, IL 60606

Sources of governmental documents are as follows:

The applicable regulations of the MPIO, USDA are contained in 9 CFR Part 200 to end. Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. These documents may be purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Services Administration
Specification Unit (WFSIS)
Room 6039
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

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Military activities should submit request for copies of this CID to:

Naval Publications and Forms Center
5801 Tabor Avenue
Philadelphia, PA 19120

Comments and suggestions.

Comments and suggestions regarding this CID may be submitted to:

Director
Market Research and Development Division
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Washington, DC 20250

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities

Army - GL
Navy - MC, MS
DP - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

HHS - FDA, NIH, IHS
USDA - MRD
DOJ - BOP
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - MRD

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